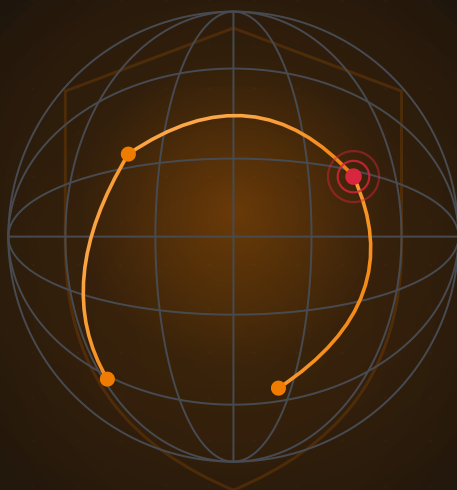




THREAT PULSE

WEEKLY CYBER THREAT BRIEFING

WEEK IN REVIEW · 24–30 AUGUST 2026

Inside this week: a **pre-auth flaw chain in widely used print-management software** actively exploited with no password needed, a **VPN gateway bug** quietly upgraded from “denial of service” to full remote takeover, and **three maximum-severity flaws** patched in a cloud platform thousands of businesses rely on — explained in plain English, with the practical steps that matter.

Welcome to **Threat Pulse**, your plain-English weekly round-up of the cyber threats making waves around the world — and what they mean for your business. This week attackers found a way to break into widely used **print-management software with no password at all**, a **VPN gateway bug** first dismissed as a minor nuisance turned out to allow full remote takeover, and a **cloud platform used by thousands of businesses** quietly patched three maximum-severity flaws before attackers could use them. No jargon, just what happened and the practical steps worth taking.

AT A GLANCE THIS WEEK

 **9.4** /10

Severity of the PaperCut print-server flaw being actively exploited this week

 **22** k+

Internet-exposed VPN gateways researchers found still vulnerable to this week's Citrix flaw

 **3**

Maximum-severity (10/10) flaws patched in one popular cloud platform this week

THIS WEEK'S HEADLINE THREAT

PAPERCUT NG/MF • CVE-2026-82078 & CVE-2026-81578

Widely used print-management software can be taken over with no password at all



CRITICAL

Exploitation: **active, limited & targeted**

WHAT'S HAPPENING

PaperCut NG and **PaperCut MF** — print-management software used by offices, schools, universities and print shops worldwide — have two flaws that, chained together, let an attacker **walk past the login screen and run their own code** on the server, no password required. PaperCut rushed out **two emergency patches in three days** (27 and 29 August) after the first didn't fully close the gap; attackers are already using it in real, if limited, attacks.

WHO'S AFFECTED

Anyone running **PaperCut NG or MF versions 24, 25 or 26** with the server's web admin interface reachable from the internet. Version 23 and earlier can't be patched at all — those need upgrading to a supported version instead.

WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU

Print management sits quietly in the background of most offices, which makes it easy to forget it's also a server with its own login — and now, its own route in for attackers. Once inside, an attacker can reach whatever else that server can see on your network, not just the printers.

Good news if your PaperCut server was never exposed to the internet (the recommended setup): the practical risk is far lower, since attackers reach this flaw through the server's public-facing web interface. Worth confirming with your IT provider either way.

! What to do about the headline threat

-  Ask your IT team or provider whether you run **PaperCut NG or MF**, and if so, confirm **Emergency Patch Release 2** (29 Aug) is installed — even if an earlier patch was already applied. Running version 23 or earlier? No patch exists — plan an upgrade instead.
-  If you can't patch immediately, make sure the PaperCut server's **web interface isn't reachable from the public internet** — restrict it to trusted internal networks.
-  Ask them to **check logs for compromise** — missing files, DB errors, or odd **pc-app.exe** activity.

OTHER THREATS WORTH KNOWING ABOUT



HIGH

A VPN gateway bug dismissed as “denial of service” turns out to be full remote takeover

Citrix quietly patched **CVE-2026-8452** in NetScaler ADC/Gateway back in June, describing it only as a way to crash the device. Security researchers have since shown it actually lets an attacker take **complete, unauthenticated control as an administrator** — and real attackers are already using it in wide, indiscriminate attacks that plant hidden backdoors. CISA added it to its actively-exploited list on 26 August with a federal deadline of 29 August; researchers count over **22,000** of these gateways still reachable from the internet.

Takeaway: don't judge a patch's urgency by its original severity label — confirm your NetScaler ADC/Gateway is on the fixed build from June.



MEDIUM

Three “perfect score” flaws patched in a cloud platform thousands of businesses use

Researchers found three flaws rated the **maximum possible severity (10 out of 10)** in ServiceNow's AI Platform, which could have let an attacker run their own code or database commands with no login at all. ServiceNow patched its own **cloud-hosted instances automatically** — most customers needed to do nothing — but a self-hosted or partner-managed instance must be patched manually. No exploitation has been confirmed so far.

Takeaway: if you use standard cloud ServiceNow you're already covered; if your instance is self-hosted or partner-managed, ask them to confirm the patch is applied.



MEDIUM

19 browser extensions were quietly stealing passwords and crypto for over two years

Researchers found 19 Chrome and Edge extensions — including one productivity tool with roughly **80,000 users** — that had secretly been stealing browser passwords, cryptocurrency wallet details and social-media logins since **February 2024**. They posed as ordinary tools like screen readers, PDF helpers and ad trackers, so nothing about them looked suspicious to the people who installed them.

Takeaway: it's worth five minutes reviewing your team's installed browser extensions and removing anything nobody remembers installing or actually uses.

★ Your 3-minute checklist this week

- ✓ Confirm any **PaperCut NG/MF** server has **Emergency Patch Release 2** installed (see previous page).
- ✓ If you use **Citrix NetScaler ADC/Gateway**, confirm it's on the fixed build from June — don't assume it was already handled.
- ✓ If **ServiceNow** is self-hosted or partner-managed for you, confirm this week's patch is applied (cloud customers are already covered).
- ✓ Have someone review your team's installed **browser extensions** and remove anything unfamiliar or unused.

Threat Pulse is provided by DPG-Cyber for general awareness only and does not constitute specific security or legal advice. Threat details are drawn from reputable public reporting as at 31 August 2026 and may evolve as investigations continue. For guidance tailored to your environment, please contact your DPG-Cyber account team.

BEHIND THE HEADLINES

Why a **watchful eye** changes the outcome

Every threat in this issue had one thing in common: the damage happened in the **quiet gap between the break-in and the moment someone noticed**. Tools alone rarely stop an attack — what limits the harm is continuous monitoring that correlates the signals, spots the intrusion early, and responds before a foothold becomes a crisis.

247 days

Average time for organisations to identify *and* contain a breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

\$4.99M

Global average total cost of a single data breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

THE WINDOW THAT MATTERS

Intrusion
the way in

Foothold
quietly settling in

Lateral movement
spreading across systems

Impact
data theft / ransomware

↑ The sooner an attack is spotted, the smaller the damage. Closing this window — detecting and responding on the left, long before impact on the right — is the entire job of a Security Operations Centre.

WHAT CONTINUOUS MONITORING QUIETLY DOES



Sees across everything

A SIEM gathers and correlates activity from across your systems, so unusual behaviour stands out instead of hiding in the noise.



Watches around the clock

Attacks don't keep office hours. A SOC means real people monitoring day, night and weekends — not just 9 to 5.



Knows the latest tactics

Fresh threat intelligence — like the appliance and supply-chain attacks in this issue — feeds detection so new tricks are recognised fast.



Acts, not just alerts

Alerts are triaged and investigated by analysts who step in early, turning a would-be incident into a non-event.

CLIENT ACTION OF THE WEEK

THIS WEEK'S FIX

Patch or isolate your PaperCut server

If you or your IT provider run **PaperCut NG or MF**, install **Emergency Patch Release 2** (29 Aug) today — and in the meantime, make sure its web interface can't be reached from the public internet.

GOOD HABIT

Roll out a password manager

A business password manager closes off the single biggest everyday risk — reused and weak passwords — and takes under an hour to set up for a small team.

This is the quiet, everyday work behind **DPG-Cyber's SIEM & SOC services** — the same monitoring and response that turns headlines like these into non-events for the businesses we look after. If you're ever curious how it would map to your own environment, we're always happy to talk it through, no pressure — just drop us a line at hello@dpg-cyber.com.